stepped out of their homes simply to watch the Yatra go by, those who walked a few hundred metres with it, and those who participated in it every day or were daily directly impacted by it—and the number goes up to more than a lakh.

The successful management of these participants on a daily, weekly and monthly basis is a testament to the organizational ability of the Indian National Congress. There were six teams just for the management of logistics of the 120 Bharat yatris. There was a team responsible for setting up camp on a daily basis, since the yatris' night-halt venue also changed every day. There were the electricity, water, vehicle-management and food/provisions teams that provided other essential services. There were more than sixty flatbed vehicles with converted containers that acted as mobile rooms, where the yatris could rest at night. There was a separate ambulance with staff to provide medical support to the yatris.

It needs to be reiterated that here we are talking about just the support structure around a few hundred people, including the Bharat yatris and some other core teams. The management of tens of thousands to lakhs of people who attended the Yatra is another story.

Take a look at the logistics around the provision of food. On any given day, breakfast and dinner would see attendants in the hundreds. Lunch around midday, when the yatris rested, saw people joining from all over, numbering in the thousands. This didn't include the separate meal packets for thousands of participants along the way.

Chalking out the Yatra's route map, selecting locations and ensuring proper security along the way were activities that required separate dedicated teams and intense scheduling, led by the imperturbable and taciturn K.B. Byju.

That the party managed to carry out this exercise with almost no hiccups over six months is a testament to its organization and logistics management. This, in the opinion of this writer (himself an MBA with a prior international corporate career), is worthy of a Harvard Business School case study.